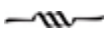
them in a white Premier Padmini Fiat car to the house in Indira Nagar. The house was filled with over a dozen injured cadres. Trichy Santhan and Irumborai were already there.[5]

Ragothaman and Verma left for Bangalore soon after Vicky's interrogation was over. The next day, Jagannathan, a real estate broker who had been in touch with Rangan when the latter was looking for houses, was picked up with the help of the Bangalore Police. The SIT had reached his doorstep through the owner of the house in Indira Nagar. The investigators' priority was to go after the fugitives. Verma had asked Jagannathan to disclose the locations of other hideouts. He broke down during the interrogation and revealed the hideout at Domalur, close to Indira Nagar. The house was immediately placed under surveillance.[6]

Around ten at night, the silhouette of a man was spotted approaching the Domalur house. The area of late had seen a spate of burglaries. A small vigilance team had been formed and local residents sprung into action, suspecting it was a thief. But it turned out to be Miresh, a sixteen-year-old LTTE guerrilla who had come to the city for medical treatment. He was waiting to be sent back to Jaffna. Cornered and fearing police arrest, Miresh unsuccessfully tried to grab his cyanide capsule. The tracking team was around, watching the drama. Neither Verma nor Ragothaman had anticipated the sudden intervention of the locals. At the Domalur hideout, the entire tracking team realized how close it had been to catching Sivarasan. According to locals, Sivarasan, Shubha and Nero had all been in the house until the day before. They were there at Domalur when the tracking team was raiding the Indira Nagar hideout to catch them—only two kilometres away.[7]



Miresh told Verma and Ragothaman that Suresh Master had moved out the injured cadres from the Domalur house when the raid was under way at the other house in Indira Nagar. As a result, he and some others were spending the night on pavements, in parks and bus stands. Ragothaman extracted the